

RIVALS

RULEBOOK

SEASON 2

COUNTER-STRIKE 2

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Rivalerna E-sportförening, org. no. 802553-8599

The Swedish version is the master text.

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1 General

1.1 Organiser and Competition

1.1.1 RIVALS CS2 Season 2 (the Competition) is a Counter-Strike 2 competition that Rivalerna E-sportförening (the Organiser), a non-profit association with organisation number 802553-8599, Välluvsvägen 5, 253 51 Påarp, runs under the name RIVALS LEAGUE.

1.1.2 The Competition has two Tracks, separate tournaments with their own tables, prizes and entry requirements, and a Team takes part in one Track. The LEGENDS track is open to all eligible Teams, with the Qualifier Stage online from 3 November 2026 and the LAN Final with four Teams on 30 January 2027 in Jönköping (section 4). The RIVALS track is an online league for developing Teams and community Teams (section 5), and nothing in it gives entry to the LEGENDS track. Participation is free of charge.

1.1.3 The LEGENDS track runs from 3 November 2026 to 30 January 2027, including the media day on 29 January 2027, and no Participant has to attend anything outside those dates. The RIVALS track runs from the Play-in on 28 October 2026, or the Group Stage on 4 November 2026, to the Grand Final on 16 December 2026. All times are Swedish time: CEST (UTC+2) until 25 October 2026, 03:00 CEST, and CET (UTC+1) thereafter.

1.1.4 The Website (rivalsleague.gg) is used for registration, tables and the Decisions Log, Challengermode for Check-in, Map Veto, servers, results and payout, and the RIVALS CS2 Discord (discord.gg/rivalsleaguecs2) for Support Tickets, which are written cases to Competition Administration. All messages to the Organiser, including Protests and Appeals, are Support Tickets, which count as received when they are created and are answered within 48 hours. During a Series, the match chat is used and questions are handled immediately.

1.1.5 The Organiser contacts the Team through the Team Captain, who informs the Team, and in slot matters in the RIVALS track also through the Slot Owner. A message published on the Website and in the RIVALS CS2 Discord is deemed to have reached all Teams.

1.1.6 The League Commissioner is the highest decision-making Official. The Head of Competitive Operations leads Competition Administration, made up of Admins, where the Admin who leads a Series is the Match Admin. The Review Committee, three people appointed by the League Commissioner for each case, hears Appeals. The Disciplinary Board, appointed by the Organiser's board and with no members from Competition Administration, decides on Cheating, Match-fixing, betting, serious misconduct and suspensions after the Competition.

1.2 Valve

1.2.1 The Competition is run in accordance with Valve's licence agreement for tournaments (Limited Game Tournament License Agreement) and Valve's Tournament Operation Requirements (Tournament Operation Requirements for Counter-Strike 2) in the version in force on 2 October 2026 (commit 8594dc0, 8 December 2025). The LEGENDS track is a Ranked Tournament at Tier 2 level and the RIVALS track is a separate Unranked Tournament.

1.2.2 The deadline for the LEGENDS track's Additional Information is Tuesday 20 October 2026, 23:59 CEST, and a newer version of the Tournament Operation Requirements that Valve publishes before the deadline applies and is set out in an addendum. A provision that conflicts with the Tournament Operation Requirements is amended under 1.3.3.

1.2.3 The Rulebook does not limit the right to take part in other tournaments. The only exception is that Participants in a Team in the LAN Final may not play in other tournaments from their arrival at the LAN Venue on 29 January 2027 until the Team's last Series on 30 January 2027 has finished.

1.2.4 All Teams in the same stage of a Track are treated equally, including in Accommodation, reimbursements, access, warm-up, practice and setup time, equipment, support, Media Obligations and rest between Series. Reimbursements are set out in 8.2.3.

1.2.5 The Competition is not endorsed or sponsored by Valve and is not affiliated with Valve in any way. Valve, Steam and Counter-Strike are trademarks of Valve Corporation.

1.3 The Rulebook, the Decisions Log and changes

1.3.1 The Rulebook consists of sections 1 to 8 and the Bracket Appendix. The Swedish text takes precedence over the English, with the same clause numbers. Headings do not affect interpretation, and a specific rule for a Track in section 4 or 5 takes precedence. Participants accept the Rulebook on registration and are bound by it until their cases and Payouts are completed, and the Team is responsible for its Participants. The Rulebook also applies to the Officials, and suspensions, bars and retained slots (5.8) continue to apply after the Competition.

1.3.2 The Rulebook is published at rivalsleague.gg/rules and in the GitHub repository github.com/RIVALS-LEAGUE/RIVALS-CS2-SEASON-2 with the full version history, and each version is archived with an independent web archiving service. Changes and Errata receive a new version number in the Changelog with the date, time and affected clauses. For each decision, the Decisions Log states the date, the decision-maker, those affected, the provision, the reasons, the consequence and how to appeal, and the entries, seed lists, Groups, registration lists, Conflict of Interest summaries, Valve approvals and the LAN Information are archived on GitHub the same day.

1.3.3 After publication, none of the following change: the eligibility requirements, the Grounds for Disqualification, the format, which stages are played online and on LAN, the competition dates, the Prize Pool, the Prize Distribution, other compensation, the VRS publication used for Seeding or the seeding method. Exceptions are made only when Valve's Tournament Operation Requirements or Swedish law require it or force majeure makes the plan impossible, through a published notice with reasons and, in the LEGENDS track, only after Valve's written approval.

1.3.4 Other provisions are changed through an entry in the Changelog that applies no earlier than 7 days after publication and never retroactively. Clarifications that do not change the meaning are Errata and apply immediately. The League Commissioner decides on changes and Errata, and that decision cannot be appealed, but its application in an individual case can. Anything stated as planned, such as dates for Groups, the match schedule and Official Broadcast, is confirmed by a notice on the Website and in the RIVALS CS2 Discord without the Rulebook being changed.

1.3.5 Competition Administration may make the decisions needed to run the Competition in situations the Rulebook does not cover, starting from the closest rule. The League Commissioner may also decide on a temporary emergency measure when the safety of the Participants, the integrity of the Competition or its delivery requires it, for no longer than the need exists and never to change what 1.3.3 locks. Such decisions are recorded in the Decisions Log and can never lead to Disqualification outside 2.7.

1.3.6 The Match Admin and the Head of Competitive Operations interpret the Rulebook, and the interpretation can be reviewed under 7.3. Swedish law and the Organiser's statutes apply and take precedence in the event of conflict.

2 Registration and eligibility

2.1 Registration and Eligibility Check

2.1.1 Registration for both Tracks is made at rivalsleague.gg/register during the Registration Window, Friday 9 October 2026, 12:00 CEST to Wednesday 21 October 2026, 23:59 CEST, and no new Teams are registered outside the window. In the RIVALS track, the Participant who registers the Team becomes the Slot Owner.

2.1.2 Slots are allocated on a First come, first served basis. A registration is complete when all mandatory fields are filled in, five Players are linked and the registration is confirmed, and the Registration Time is when the Website marks it as complete. Until the Groups are published, the Website shows a public list for each Track with order number, team, tag, Registration Time to the second, status and available slots, which is saved on GitHub when the window closes and when the Groups are published.

2.1.3 The Team chooses its Track on registration and may switch during the Registration Window, with the switch counting as a new Registration Time. After the window, a Team switches Track only under 4.2.1, 4.2.2 and 5.2.3, and never after its first Map.

2.1.4 Each Track has room for at most 32 Teams, and a Team that registers when the Track is full goes onto the Track's Waitlist in registration order, which it may leave at any time. A slot that becomes free before the Groups are published goes to the first Team on the Waitlist, in the RIVALS track only until the Play-in matchups have been published and in the LEGENDS track with the addition in 4.2.2. After that, slots are filled only under 4.7 and 5.6.

2.1.5 The registration states, among other things, name, date of birth, player name, SteamID64, Swedish *personnummer* (Swedish personal identity number) or *samordningsnummer* (coordination number) and contact details, and for anyone under 18 the Guardian's details and consent. The Participant is responsible for ensuring that the details are correct and up to date.

2.1.6 By registering, the Team and each Participant undertake to follow the Rulebook and the decisions made under it, to fulfil the Media Obligations and to grant the use of name and image under section 8, and a Team in the LEGENDS track undertakes to play the LAN Final in person if it qualifies (4.6.2). A Participation Agreement issued by the Organiser, the same for everyone and published, must be signed and gives way to the Rulebook.

2.1.7 Personal data is processed under the GDPR only for registration, eligibility checks, running the Competition, payout and contact, and *personnummer*, *samordningsnummer* and identity documents are seen only by those who carry out the Eligibility Check. The Organiser publishes only team name, tag, player name, SteamID64 to the extent Challengermode shows it, registration order, the Decisions Log and Conflict of Interest summaries, and deletes everything else when all cases are settled, except what is needed for the Decisions Log, suspensions, retained slots or by law.

2.1.8 Competition Administration carries out the Eligibility Check from Thursday 22 October 2026, 00:00 CEST to Sunday 25 October 2026, 23:59 CET for each Participant in a Team with a slot or on a Waitlist, on the basis of written documentation, and checks 2.2 to 2.6, 2.8, grounds 1 to 4 in 2.7 and names under 3.5. The check is repeated on each addition and before the LAN Final, and supplementary information may be requested with a 72-hour response deadline, though an identity document may be requested only under 2.2.3.

2.1.9 By 25 October 2026, 23:59 CET at the latest, the Head of Competitive Operations informs the Team Captain, and in the RIVALS track the Slot Owner, which Participants are approved, with reasons for anyone who is not. Anyone who is not approved may not play, and the decision is published in the Decisions Log the same day. New information about a possible Ground for Disqualification is assessed when it comes in.

2.2 Age and guardians

2.2.1 A Participant must have turned 13 on the day the Participant is registered in the Team.

2.2.2 A Participant under 18 submits written consent from the Guardian on registration and may not play until it has been received. The consent covers the Rulebook, name and image in media, processing of personal data, Akros Anti-Cheat (6.2) and Payout of prizes, and states whether prizes may be paid to the Participant's own account on Challengermode.

2.2.3 The Head of Competitive Operations may request a valid identity document only when the registered name, date of birth and *personnummer* or *samordningsnummer* do not match each other, or when a Protest claims that the date of birth is wrong or that the number does not belong to the Participant. The request is made by Support Ticket with a 72-hour response deadline.

2.3 Residence

2.3.1 At least three of the five Players in the Starting Lineup must be permanently resident in Sweden in every Map, in both Tracks and all stages. A person is permanently resident in Sweden if they are registered with a Swedish *personnummer* or *samordningsnummer* on registration or addition. The number decides, not where the person lives, and citizenship or other documentation is neither required nor accepted.

2.3.2 If 2.3.1 is not met in a Map, the Team loses the Series by Forfeit, even if the breach is discovered afterwards. A repeated breach is Ground for Disqualification 7.

2.4 Game Account

2.4.1 Each Player and Substitute has a single Game Account, registered with SteamID64 on the Website and Challengermode. Prime status is not required. The account must belong to the Participant, may not be used by anyone else and is used throughout the Competition.

2.4.2 Before the Registration Window closes, the account may be changed freely on the Website. After that, it may be changed only if it has been hijacked or compromised, by Support Ticket no later than 24 hours before the Team's next Series, and the Head of Competitive Operations approves the change if the new account belongs to the same Participant and meets 2.4 and 2.5. A ban on the old account still counts.

2.4.3 If a Map is played on another of the Participant's own accounts than the registered one, the Team loses the Series, but if the error is discovered before the Map is live it is corrected without Sanction. Deliberate use of another account is assessed under 2.7, and playing on another person's account is ground 4. The Organiser's technical measures against Cheating are set out in 6.1 and 6.2.

2.5 VAC and game bans

2.5.1 A Player or Substitute is ineligible if an account that the person has registered or used in Counter-Strike 2 or an earlier game in the series has a VAC ban or game ban in such a game that took effect less than five years before 21 October 2026, 23:59 CEST. A later ban makes the person ineligible from the date of issue, and the consequences are set out in ground 1 in 2.7.

2.5.2 Each Player and Substitute confirms on registration that no such ban exists, and Competition Administration checks Steam's public data at the Eligibility Check, on each addition and before the LAN Final and archives the check. A ban in another game does not count if this is supported by documentation from Steam. If a ban is discovered during a Series, the current Map is played to the end, but the Player plays no further Maps until the Head of Competitive Operations has decided.

2.6 One person, one Team

2.6.1 A Participant may be registered in at most one Team at a time, regardless of Track and role. A Coach who was registered when the Team played a Map may not be registered in another Team for the rest of the Competition.

2.6.2 A Player or Substitute who has played a Map for a Team may not be registered in or play for another Team for the rest of the Competition, in any Track (team lock), even if the Participant is removed or the Team withdraws or is disqualified. Anyone who was in the Starting Lineup when the Map went live (6.7.2) has played it. The rule applies only to the Competition.

2.7 Grounds for Disqualification

2.7.1 Only the grounds in the table can lead to Disqualification of a Team or a Participant, and they apply equally to everyone regardless of Track, Seeding or stage. No other grounds lead to Disqualification, and no Sanction under 7.4, alone or together with others, leads to it.

No.	Ground	Trigger	Consequence
1	VAC ban or game ban	A ban under 2.5.1 exists on an account that the Participant registers or has used in a Counter-Strike title.	The Participant is disqualified. If the ban existed when the Registration Window closed on 21 October 2026, 23:59 CEST and the Participant has played a Map for the Team, the Team is also disqualified. If the ban came later, the Team loses by Forfeit every Series in which the Participant has played a Map from the date of issue onwards, regardless of the result in the game.
2	External sanction	A sanction for cheating, match-fixing or betting that is published by Valve, by ESIC in ESIC's sanctions register or by a tournament organiser on a public sanctions list and that applies on the day the check is made.	The Participant is disqualified for as long as the sanction applies.
3	Suspension in RIVALS LEAGUE	A suspension or expulsion of the person or the Team in the Sanctions Register (RIVALS LEAGUE's public register on the Website), decided under section 7 or by the Disciplinary Board, that applies on the day the check is made. A Sanction under 7.4 does not count.	The Participant or the Team is disqualified for as long as the suspension applies.
4	Incorrect information or another person's account	a) Information about identity, age or residence given on registration or on an addition is incorrect and is relevant to Eligibility. b) Someone plays a Map on a Game Account that belongs to another person.	The Participant is disqualified. The Team is disqualified if the Participant has played a Map for the Team or if b has occurred in a Map that the Team has played.
5	Cheating, Match-fixing or Betting	The Disciplinary Board has, after reviewing the Demo and other evidence, established that the person is guilty of Cheating, Match-fixing or Betting relating to the Competition.	The person is disqualified. If the person is a Participant in a Team, the Team is also disqualified.
6	Withdrawal	a) The Team Captain, or in the RIVALS track the Slot Owner, gives written notice that the Team will not continue in the Track. b) A Team in the LAN Final has fewer than three Players from the VRS Roster checked in on site at the check-in time on 29 January 2027 (4.6.2), unless the second sentence of 4.7.2 applies.	Before the start: the Team is disqualified from the Competition without further Sanction. After the start: the Team is disqualified, and those set out in 2.7.3 may not take part in RIVALS CS2 Season 3 or Season 4, in any Track. Case b is always a Withdrawal after the start.
7	Residence or VRS Roster, repeated breach	The Team breaches 2.3.1 or, in the LEGENDS track, 3.4.2 in a Map after already having lost a Series because of such a breach.	The Team is disqualified. On the first breach, the Team loses the Series by Forfeit, even if the breach is discovered afterwards (2.3.2 and 3.4.3).

No.	Ground	Trigger	Consequence
8	Unregistered or ineligible Player	A person plays a Map for the Team without being registered in the Team's Roster for the Series, or despite not meeting 2.2, 2.5 or 2.6, not being approved in the Eligibility Check, being locked to another Team or being disqualified.	The Team is disqualified. If the ineligibility is due solely to a ban under 2.5.1 that was issued after the Registration Window closed, the consequence in ground 1 applies instead.
9	Missing declaration or identity document, or undisclosed Business Relationship	a) A Participant who was registered when the Registration Window closed has not submitted a Conflict of Interest Declaration by 25 October 2026, 23:59 CET (for later additions, 2.8.1 and 3.2.2 apply). b) A Participant has not responded to a written request for an identity document under 2.2.3 within 72 hours. c) A Participant has left out of their Conflict of Interest Declaration a Business Relationship that existed when the declaration was submitted, or has not reported a new or changed Business Relationship within 48 hours.	In cases a and b, the Participant is disqualified. In case c, the Team is disqualified if the relationship concerns the Organiser, an Official or another Team in the same Track, and in all other instances of case c the Participant is removed from the Roster.
10	Serious misconduct	The Disciplinary Board has established that the person, in connection with the Competition, has threatened another person, spread another person's private information to cause harm (doxxing) or subjected another person to discriminatory harassment.	The person is disqualified for the rest of the Competition.

2.7.2 The Head of Competitive Operations decides under grounds 1 to 4 and 6 to 9, and the Disciplinary Board under grounds 5 and 10, within the deadlines in 7.2.4, and until then the Head of Competitive Operations may suspend the Participant from play. Decisions on Disqualification are made in writing with the ground, facts, evidence and consequence, are communicated to the Team Captain and the Participant and are published in the Decisions Log the same day with the deadline for Appeal.

2.7.3 The Competition has started at 00:00 CET on the Track's first match day: Tuesday 3 November 2026 in the LEGENDS track and, in the RIVALS track, Wednesday 28 October 2026 if there is a Play-in, otherwise Wednesday 4 November 2026. A Withdrawal is notified by Support Ticket by the Team Captain or the Slot Owner. The bar following a Withdrawal after the start applies to the Team, its organisation, the Slot Owner and the Players and Substitutes who were registered at the time of the Withdrawal.

2.7.4 If the Team itself corrects incorrect information by Support Ticket no later than 25 October 2026, 23:59 CET, before Competition Administration has raised it, this does not lead to Disqualification under ground 4. The consequences of a Disqualification for prize money are set out in 8.2.3, and for results and the table in 6.8.3 and 6.8.4.

2.8 Conflict of Interest

2.8.1 Officials are all staff under 5.3 of Valve's Tournament Operation Requirements: the League Commissioner, the Head of Competitive Operations, Admins, the Disciplinary Board, the Review Committee, commentators, presenters and production in the LEGENDS track, and the Organiser's board. A Business Relationship is, for example, shared management or ownership, licensing, loans, employment and paid assignments, directly or through an organisation. Each Participant submits Valve's Declaration of Conflicts of Interest form (Conflict of Interest Declaration) covering relationships with the Organiser, Officials and other Teams, even when there are none, by Sunday 25 October 2026, 23:59 CET at the latest, and on later additions under 3.2.2. The Team Captain also declares for the organisation, and the Guardian signs for anyone under 18.

2.8.2 Officials declare to the League Commissioner by 7 October 2026, 23:59 CEST and renew their declaration by 23 October 2026, 23:59 CEST, or before a later assignment begins. New or changed relationships are reported within 48 hours. A Participant who fails to do so is assessed under ground 9 in 2.7, and an Official who fails to do so is removed from all roles in the LEGENDS track and the relationship is disclosed to Valve.

2.8.3 An Official with a Business Relationship with a Team in the LEGENDS track, or who is a Participant there themselves, has no role in the Track unless the relationship has been disclosed to Valve and published and Valve has not objected within 90 days. In the RIVALS track, and in the case of any other Conflict of Interest such as close family ties, the Official handles nothing that concerns the Team. The Organiser discloses the Officials' relationships to Valve and itself has no relationships with Teams in the LEGENDS track without disclosure, publication and approval under 5.3 of Valve's Tournament Operation Requirements. Summaries without personal data are published no later than together with the Groups.

3 Roster

3.1 Composition and roles

3.1.1 A Roster has five Players, at most two Substitutes and at most one Coach, who may play only as a registered Substitute. At most seven people may play for a Team during the Competition, and anyone who has played a Map counts even after being removed. Removing a Participant and moving a Substitute to Player are done by Support Ticket and do not change the VRS Roster.

3.1.2 The Team Captain, who may be a Player, Substitute or Coach, represents the Team and binds it in scheduling, Map Veto, results and Protests, and is changed by Support Ticket. In the RIVALS track, the Slot Owner, who may be the Team Captain, holds the Team's slot. The LEGENDS track has no Slot Owners and no retained slots.

3.2 Additions

3.2.1 The Team may add Substitutes and a Coach within the limits in 3.1.1 until the end of the Group Stage, which in the LEGENDS track is Sunday 10 January 2027, 23:59 CET and in the RIVALS track is set under 5.5.3, and after that no Participants at all. The Organiser records the Roster when the Registration Window closes and when the Group Stage ends.

3.2.2 An addition is complete when the registration details, the Conflict of Interest Declaration and, for anyone under 18, the Guardian's consent have been received. The new Participant plays from the next Series if the addition was complete no later than 24 hours before its start, otherwise from the Series after that, and only once Eligibility and, in the RIVALS track, the bars in 5.2.1 have been cleared, which is communicated no later than two hours before the start.

3.3 Substitutions and Starting Lineup

3.3.1 The Starting Lineup, the five who play a Map, may consist only of eligible Players and Substitutes in the Roster, must meet 2.3.1 and, in the LEGENDS track, 3.4.2, and is changed only between Maps. It is confirmed at Check-in (6.5.1) and, before the next Map, on Challengermode or to the Match Admin within 5 minutes after the previous Map, otherwise the same lineup applies.

3.3.2 A Starting Lineup that breaches the requirements, for example by differing from the confirmed one, results in a Map Forfeit, which may be increased to loss of the Series. A breach of 2.3.1 or 3.4.2 always results in loss of the Series by Forfeit (2.3.2 and 3.4.3).

3.4 VRS Roster in the LEGENDS track

3.4.1 The VRS Roster is the five Players registered in the Starting Lineup when the Registration Window closes on 21 October 2026, 23:59 CEST, or fewer if the Team has fewer at that time, and they are the Team's Core Players. It applies unchanged throughout the Track and is not affected by additions or substitutions, and a replacement Team under 4.7 keeps its own.

3.4.2 At least three Core Players must play the whole of every Map in the Group Stage, the Quarterfinals and the LAN Final, in addition to the requirement in 2.3.1. A temporary loss of connection does not breach the requirement as long as no one replaces the Core Player during the Map.

3.4.3 If 3.4.2 is not met in a Map, the Team loses the Series by Forfeit, and a repeated breach is Ground for Disqualification 7. The Organiser records the SteamID64 of the five on each Map and checks 2.3.1 and 3.4.2 after each Map. A Series that has breached section 3 is never reported as a played ranked result but as a Forfeit.

3.5 Names and sponsors

3.5.1 Each Team registers a team name and a tag, which the Head of Competitive Operations must approve. Team names, tags and player names may not contain offensive content, names of skin gambling or case opening websites, or Valve's trademarks. Sponsor content may not breach the Steam Subscriber Agreement or Valve's licence agreement, and gambling companies may be sponsors only if they hold a Swedish licence.

4 The LEGENDS track

4.1 Status

4.1.1 The LEGENDS track is open to all Teams that meet section 2, including Teams without a VRS rank, and is a Ranked Tournament at Tier 2 level without direct VRS invitations, wildcard invitations or retained slots, so information on filters, starting rank and the VRS publication for invitations does not apply.

4.1.2 The Track consists of the Qualifier Stage online, that is the Group Stage and, with 17 to 32 Teams, the Quarterfinals, and the LAN Final, which corresponds to Valve's Main Stage. All four places in the LAN Final are decided through open qualification in the Qualifier Stage, and a replacement Team has always played there.

4.1.3 Valve decides whether the results count towards the Valve Regional Standings (VRS). The Organiser has not received a decision and promises neither VRS status nor HLTV coverage, which is sought only for the LAN Final. The LAN Final is held and the Prize Pool of SEK 30,000 is paid out regardless, provided the minimum number of Teams under 4.2 is reached.

4.2 Field and format

4.2.1 The Track has room for at most 32 Teams on a First come, first served basis. If fewer than 16 are registered when the Registration Window closes on 21 October 2026, 23:59 CEST, the Track is postponed, and the Organiser publishes a new timetable by 28 October 2026, 23:59 CET at the latest. The Teams may then withdraw without Sanction or, outside the bars in 5.2.1, move to the RIVALS track by Support Ticket before 26 October 2026, 00:00 CET.

4.2.2 Teams that drop out before the Groups are published are replaced from the Waitlist, first by registrations beyond 32 in order and then by Teams in the RIVALS track that have requested a move, which they may do only when the RIVALS track has fewer than four Teams and as long as the LEGENDS track has fewer than 16. If 8 to 15 Teams remain, two Groups that are as even as possible are played under 4.2.3, and fewer than 8 Teams postpones the Track under 4.2.1.

4.2.3 With 16 Teams, Group A and Group B, with eight Teams each, play a Single Round Robin, where everyone plays everyone once, in Bo3 over seven rounds, and the first and second placed Teams in each Group go directly to the LAN Final. A1 is the winner of Group A and A2 the runner-up, and so on. Semifinal 1 is A1 against B2 and Semifinal 2 is B1 against A2.

4.2.4 With 17 to 32 Teams, Groups A to D, with at most eight Teams each and at most one Team's difference between them, play a Single Round Robin in Bo3 with Byes where needed. The first and second placed Teams go to Quarterfinal 1 A1 against B2, Quarterfinal 2 D1 against C2, Quarterfinal 3 B1 against A2 and Quarterfinal 4 C1 against D2. In the LAN Final, the winners of Quarterfinals 1 and 2 meet in Semifinal 1 and the winners of 3 and 4 in Semifinal 2.

4.2.5 Group placings are decided under 6.8. The bracket is fixed and published before the Group Stage begins, and there is no reseeding. The LAN Final is played as Single Elimination: the Semifinal winners meet in the Final and the losers in the Third-place Match.

4.3 Seeding

4.3.1 Seeding is based on Valve's global VRS publication for invitations dated 5 October 2026 (invitation/2026/standings_global_2026_10_05.md in github.com/ValveSoftware/counter-strike_regional_standings), never on the "live" folder, and, if that publication does not exist on 21 October 2026, 23:59 CEST, on the latest global publication before that time. The publication is final even if Valve later changes it. For Teams without a Global VRS Rank, the HLTV World Ranking in the latest version available on 22 October 2026 is used, and it is archived and linked with the seed list.

4.3.2 A Team has a VRS rank or HLTV Points when a ranked roster has at least three Players in common with the VRS Roster, and if there are several matches the best one applies. Teams with a VRS rank are placed first by rank, with equal rank decided by HLTV Points and then by draw, then Teams by HLTV Points and last all other Teams by draw, and HLTV Points and the draw never break the VRS order. The matching is reported per Team, and the draw is recorded in front of a witness who is not an Official, using a random number generator whose method and seed value are published.

4.3.3 The Teams are distributed across the Groups by Snake Seeding, with two Groups A, B, B, A and with four Groups A, B, C, D, D, C, B, A, repeated (B.2). The seed list, the sources, the matching and the recording are published with the Groups, as planned on Monday 26 October 2026, 18:00 CET. The Higher Seed in each stage is set out in 6.6.2.

4.4 Calendar

4.4.1 The calendar applies when the Track is run under 4.2. A planned date is confirmed in the match schedule and changed under 1.3.4, and a confirmed date is changed only under 1.3.3.

Date	Time	Activity	Status
Friday 9 October 2026	12:00 CEST	The Registration Window opens	confirmed
Wednesday 21 October 2026	23:59 CEST	The Registration Window closes. Roster and VRS Roster are recorded	confirmed
Thursday 22 October 2026		The latest HLTV World Ranking available on this date is used for Seeding	confirmed
22 to 25 October 2026		Eligibility Check	confirmed
Monday 26 October 2026	18:00 CET	Groups, seed list and recording of the draw are published	planned
Wednesday 28 October 2026	18:00 CET	Match schedule for the Group Stage and information for Team Captains are published	planned
Tuesday 3 November 2026	19:00 CET	Group Stage round 1	confirmed

Date	Time	Activity	Status
Tuesday 10, 17 and 24 November and 1, 8 and 15 December 2026	19:00 CET	Group Stage rounds 2 to 7	planned
16 December 2026 to 6 January 2027		Christmas break. No regular Series are scheduled	planned
7 to 10 January 2027		Reserve dates for postponed Group Stage Series and Tiebreaker Deciders	confirmed
Sunday 10 January 2027	23:59 CET	Group Stage completed, except in the event of an extension under 4.4.3. Roster and VRS Roster are recorded, no additions after this	confirmed
Saturday 16 January 2027	13:00 and 16:00 CET	Quarterfinal 1 and Quarterfinal 2, only with 17 to 32 Teams	confirmed
Sunday 17 January 2027	13:00 and 16:00 CET	Quarterfinal 3 and Quarterfinal 4, only with 17 to 32 Teams	confirmed
Wednesday 20 January 2027	18:00 CET	Latest time for the LAN Information	confirmed
Wednesday 27 January 2027	18:00 CET	Deadline for offering a Vacancy in the LAN Final	confirmed
Friday 29 January 2027	As set out in the LAN Information, between 12:00 and 18:00 CET	Arrival, on-site check-in and media day. Attendance is mandatory	confirmed
Saturday 30 January 2027	From 10:00 CET	The LAN Final: Semifinals, Third-place Match and Final	confirmed
29 to 31 January 2027		Accommodation for the Teams in the LAN Final	confirmed
Tuesday 9 February 2027	23:59 CET	Deadline for Payout of prizes	confirmed
Sunday 14 February 2027	23:59 CET	Last day to apply for Travel Reimbursement	confirmed
Tuesday 16 March 2027		Last day for Payout of Travel Reimbursement	confirmed

4.4.2 The match schedule gives each Team an average of one Series per week, and all Series in the Group Stage must be played by 10 January 2027, 23:59 CET. The times on the reserve dates are set after the Team Captains have been consulted. No Series is played or rescheduled during the Christmas break from 16 December 2026 up to and including 6 January 2027.

4.4.3 In the event of force majeure or a platform failure under 6.4, the Head of Competitive Operations may, through a published notice, extend the Group Stage for the affected Series until 14 January 2027, 23:59 CET at the latest. The dates of the Quarterfinals do not change, and the Roster is still locked on 10 January 2027.

4.5 Quarterfinals

4.5.1 The Quarterfinals are played online at the times in 4.4.1, and the second Quarterfinal on the same day starts no earlier than when the first has finished, with 6.5 counted from the start time the Match Admin announces. They are broadcast so that all four can be followed on Twitch and are Broadcast-locked Series (6.4.2 and 6.4.3). The Map Pool under 6.1.4 also applies unchanged in the LAN Final.

4.6 The LAN Final

4.6.1 The LAN Final is played on Saturday 30 January 2027 at RIVALS studio at GRO36, Huskvarnavägen 82, 554 66 Jönköping, without an audience and with a broadcast on Twitch and the Website, and the visa region is the Schengen Area, Sweden. Community casters commentate the Third-place Match. By Wednesday 20 January 2027, 18:00 CET at the latest, the LAN Information is published with the check-in time, the media day schedule, permitted peripherals and how configuration files are submitted.

4.6.2 A qualified Team must be in Jönköping on 29 January 2027 for arrival, check-in and Media Obligations and on 30 January 2027 for the Series, and no one plays remotely. The check-in time is the same for all four Teams and falls between 12:00 and 18:00 CET on 29 January 2027.

4.6.3 The Third-place Match and the Final are played in parallel on two match stations with identical equipment. No Series starts before the earliest time in the table or within 45 minutes after either of the Teams finished a Series the same day, of which at least 30 minutes is setup time. The Match Admin announces the actual start time, and 6.5 is counted from it.

Series	Earliest start
Semifinal 1	10:00 CET
Semifinal 2	14:00 CET
Third-place Match	17:30 CET
Final	18:00 CET

4.6.4 The Organiser provides computers, monitors, chairs, headsets and spare equipment, and Players bring their own mouse, mouse pad, keyboard and earphones according to the list, which are checked before use. Other equipment, Input Automation (7.1.1), personal software other than manufacturer drivers approved by an Admin, and modified game files are prohibited.

4.6.5 During a Series, only the Team's five Players, its registered Coach and the Organiser's staff may be in the player area, and phones are handed in, switched off, to the staff. During a Map, no one there has contact with anyone outside, and the Coach's role follows 6.3.4. Alcohol and drugs are prohibited, the Team is responsible for any damage its Participants cause, and section 7 applies in full.

4.6.6 A Participant under 18 takes part only with registered consent from the Guardian, and the Team names an adult contact person who is reachable throughout 29 and 30 January 2027. The room allocation requires the Guardian's written consent, and the Organiser does not take over the Guardian's responsibility.

4.6.7 Each Team receives three double rooms for five Players and one Coach from 29 to 31 January 2027, paid for by the Organiser (Accommodation), and up to SEK 5,000 for actual travel costs (Travel Reimbursement), which is applied for with supporting documents by Support Ticket no later than 14 February 2027, 23:59 CET and paid no later than 16 March 2027. Accommodation and Travel Reimbursement are not part of the Prize Pool.

4.6.8 If a Series cannot be completed on 30 January 2027 because of force majeure or a failure of the platform or venue, an interrupted Map is played to the end the same day if possible, otherwise the Higher Seed under 6.6.2 wins, with placing and prize according to the bracket. The decision can be appealed to the Review Committee within 24 hours, but the appeal does not suspend it, and no Series is moved from 30 January 2027.

4.7 Withdrawals and vacancies

4.7.1 A Withdrawal before or after 3 November 2026, 00:00 CET has the consequences in ground 6 in 2.7, and the results are handled under 6.8.4. The decisions are published in the Decisions Log the same day.

4.7.2 A Team in the LAN Final without at least three Core Players checked in at the check-in time on 29 January 2027 has made a Withdrawal after the start (ground 6 b). In the event of documented force majeure (6.4.5), the Team keeps its place if three Core Players are on site before its Semifinal on 30 January 2027, otherwise the opponent wins by Forfeit, but the Team keeps the fourth-place prize and ground 6 b does not apply. A Team that knows that fewer than three will be there notifies this by Support Ticket without delay.

4.7.3 A Vacancy arises when a Team with a place in the Quarterfinals or the LAN Final withdraws or is disqualified, and it is filled only there, never in the Group Stage. It is offered to the highest-placed Team in the same Group that did not advance, and with 17 to 32 Teams a Semifinal place is offered first to the loser of the Quarterfinal that the withdrawing Team won and then to the loser of the other Quarterfinal leading to the same Semifinal. Teams that have withdrawn or been disqualified are offered nothing.

4.7.4 The Team responds in writing within 24 hours, otherwise the offer passes to the next Team. The replacement Team must meet section 2 and 3.4.2, takes over the place and the path in the bracket and keeps its VRS Roster, and if no Team accepts, the opponent advances by Forfeit (6.8.3). Offers of a place in the LAN Final are made no later than Wednesday 27 January 2027, 18:00 CET, and a later Vacancy is not filled.

4.8 Prizes

4.8.1 The Prize Pool is SEK 30,000 and the distribution is final. The Third-place Match decides third and fourth place, and the Qualifier Stage gives no prizes. In the event of a double Forfeit, 6.5.6 applies, and Payout is made under 8.2.

Placing	Prize
1st	SEK 15,000
2nd	SEK 9,000
3rd	SEK 4,000
4th	SEK 2,000
Total	SEK 30,000

5 The RIVALS track

5.1 Status

5.1.1 The RIVALS track is a recurring league for developing Teams and community Teams and a separate Unranked Tournament, where Valve's Tournament Operation Requirements let the Organiser decide entry, even without open qualification, and therefore allow retained slots (5.8). The Track is played entirely online without a LAN final or media day, and the Organiser does not pay for Accommodation or travel.

5.2 Entry and placement

5.2.1 A Team is ineligible if at least three of its Players and Substitutes a) are in the same ranked roster in Valve's global VRS publication for invitations dated 5 October 2026, or the latest one before 9 October 2026, 12:00 CEST (the VRS Bar), or b) were in the same Roster in the playoffs of RIVALS CS2 Division 1 in Season 1 (the Season 1 Bar). Teams with players from those playoffs are checked only against the Season 1 Bar.

5.2.2 The bars are checked on registration, with an immediate response, and on each addition, and an addition that triggers a bar is not approved. A barred Team may register in the LEGENDS track as long as there are slots available. No other placement assessment is made, and after the Registration Window no Team is moved because of its competitive level.

5.2.3 The Track goes ahead if at least four Teams are eligible and placed when the Eligibility Check ends on 25 October 2026, 23:59 CET. Otherwise, the decision is published in the Decisions Log, the Teams may, before the Groups are published, request a place on the LEGENDS track's Waitlist under 4.2.2, and a Team that does not get a place loses its registration without Sanction.

5.2.4 The Track accepts at most 32 Teams in registration order, and Teams moving under 4.2.1 take only free slots. The Group Stage holds at most 16 Teams, and if there are more, the Play-in reduces the field to 16.

5.3 Format

5.3.1 The number of eligible Teams after the Eligibility Check decides the format:

Number of Teams	Play-in (Bo3, Wednesday 28 October 2026, 19:00 CET)	Group Stage (Single Round Robin, Bo3)	Group rounds	Playoffs (Double Elimination, Bo3)
0 to 3	The Track does not go ahead (5.2.3)			
4	None	One Group of 4 Teams	3	All four Teams, four-team bracket
5	None	One Group of 5 Teams, one Bye per round	5	The top four, four-team bracket
6	None	One Group of 6 Teams	5	The top four, four-team bracket
7	1 Series: seed 6 against seed 7	One Group of 6 Teams	5	The top four, four-team bracket
8	None	Two Groups of 4 Teams	3	The top two in each Group, four-team bracket
9	None	One Group of 5 Teams and one of 4 Teams	5	The top two in each Group, four-team bracket
10	None	Two Groups of 5 Teams	5	The top two in each Group, four-team bracket
11	None	One Group of 6 Teams and one of 5 Teams	5	The top two in each Group, four-team bracket
12	None	Two Groups of 6 Teams	5	The top two in each Group, four-team bracket
13	1 Series: seed 12 against seed 13	Two Groups of 6 Teams	5	The top two in each Group, four-team bracket
14	2 Series: 11 against 14, 12 against 13	Two Groups of 6 Teams	5	The top two in each Group, four-team bracket
15	3 Series: 10 against 15, 11 against 14, 12 against 13	Two Groups of 6 Teams	5	The top two in each Group, four-team bracket
16	None	Four Groups of 4 Teams	3	The top two in each Group, eight-team bracket
17 to 32	Number of Teams minus 16 Series between the lowest-seeded Teams	Four Groups of 4 Teams	3	The top two in each Group, eight-team bracket

5.3.2 In the Play-in, the highest-seeded remaining Team plays the lowest-seeded, for example with 20 Teams 13 against 20, 14 against 19, 15 against 18 and 16 against 17, and the matchups are published with the seed list on 26 October 2026, 18:00 CET. The winner takes the opponent's place in the list, and the loser is eliminated without Sanction but keeps its place in the registration order. The Groups are published as planned on Thursday 29 October 2026, 18:00 CET.

5.3.3 A Bye gives no Table Points, and the table follows 6.8. With one Group, the top four go to the Playoffs, and with two or four Groups the top two in each Group, and all other Teams are eliminated. The Group Stage ends for all Groups under 5.5.3.

5.3.4 The Playoffs are Double Elimination with an Upper Bracket and a Lower Bracket in Bo3 with no map advantage. The Grand Final is a single Series with no bracket reset if the Team from the Lower Bracket wins. The choice of Team A or Team B follows 6.6.2.

5.3.5 The bracket is fixed, published before the Group Stage begins on Wednesday 4 November 2026, 19:00 CET, and filled by group placing without reseeding. Matchups and final placings follow B.6 and B.7.

5.4 Seeding

5.4.1 Seeding is done as in the LEGENDS track (4.3.1 and 4.3.2), in practice mostly by draw, and is published on Monday 26 October 2026, 18:00 CET with sources and the recording. With one Group, all Teams are placed in Group A, otherwise Snake Seeding under 4.3.3 is used, and after the Play-in the list under 5.3.2 is used for Groups, Map Veto and Tiebreakers.

5.5 Calendar

5.5.1 The Band is set when the field is known on 26 October 2026 and is published with the seed list. The publication dates and the round dates after the first round are planned and are confirmed under 1.3.4. All Series are played at 19:00 CET.

Date	Band A (4 or 8 Teams)	Band B (5 to 7 or 9 to 15 Teams)	Band C (16 or more Teams)
Monday 26 October 2026, 18:00 CET	Seeding and Groups published	Seeding published. Groups (5, 6, 9 to 12 Teams) or Play-in matchups and information for the Team Captains (7, 13 to 15 Teams)	Seeding published. Groups (16 Teams) or Play-in matchups and information for the Team Captains (17 to 32 Teams)
Wednesday 28 October 2026	No match	Play-in (7, 13, 14 and 15 Teams)	Play-in (17 to 32 Teams)
Thursday 29 October 2026, 18:00 CET	No action	Groups published after the Play-in	Groups published after the Play-in
Wednesday 4 November 2026	Group round 1	As Band A	As Band A
Wednesday 11 November 2026	Group round 2	As Band A	As Band A
Wednesday 18 November 2026	Group round 3	As Band A	As Band A
Monday 23 November 2026	No match	Group round 4	Reserve day for the Group Stage
Wednesday 25 November 2026	Reserve day for the Group Stage	Group round 5	Upper quarterfinals (playoff round 1)
Monday 30 November 2026	No match	Reserve day for the Group Stage	Upper semifinals and lower round 1
Wednesday 2 December 2026	Upper semifinals	As Band A	Upper final and lower round 2
Monday 7 December 2026	Upper final and lower round 1	As Band A	Lower round 3
Wednesday 9 December 2026	Lower final	As Band A	As Band A
10 to 13 December 2026	No matches	As Band A	As Band A
Monday 14 December 2026	Reserve day for the Playoffs	As Band A	As Band A
Wednesday 16 December 2026	Grand Final, online	As Band A	As Band A
Thursday 17 December 2026	Reserve day for the Grand Final, only under 5.5.4	As Band A	As Band A
Saturday 26 December 2026, 23:59 CET	Deadline for Payout of prizes, or Sunday 27 December 2026, 23:59 CET if the Grand Final is played on 17 December	As Band A	As Band A

5.5.2 The reserve days are used for postponed Series and Tiebreaker Deciders. No Series are played or rescheduled from Thursday 10 December up to and including Sunday 13 December 2026.

5.5.3 The Group Stage ends for all Groups at 23:59 CET on the Band's reserve day for the Group Stage, which is 25 November 2026 in Band A, 30 November 2026 in Band B and 23 November 2026 in Band C, after which 3.2.1 applies. In the event of force majeure or a platform failure under 6.4, the Head of Competitive Operations may, through a published notice, extend it by at most one week for the affected Series, in which case the Playoff rounds are moved by the same amount but never beyond 14 December 2026, while the Grand Final and the Roster lock stay fixed.

5.5.4 The Head of Competitive Operations may move the Grand Final to Thursday 17 December 2026, 19:00 CET only if an incident outside the Teams' control prevents it from being played on 16 December 2026, for example a platform failure, force majeure or a double Forfeit under 6.5.6, and this takes precedence over 6.4.4. If it cannot be played on 17 December 2026 either, 6.4.5 applies.

5.6 Withdrawals and vacancies

5.6.1 A Withdrawal before or after the start (2.7.3) has the consequences in ground 6 in 2.7, and the results are handled under 6.8.4. In the Play-in, the opponent wins by Forfeit. A Vacancy is filled only in the Playoffs, by the highest-placed Team in the same Group that did not advance and then by the next in order, which takes over the place in the bracket. If there is no such Team, the Series against that place are decided by Forfeit (6.8.3).

5.7 Prizes

5.7.1 The Prize Pool is SEK 5,000. Third place goes to the loser of the lower final, no Third-place Match is played, and placings 4 and below receive no prize. In the event of a double Forfeit in the Grand Final, 6.5.6 applies, and Payout is made under 8.2.

Placing	Prize
1st	SEK 3,000
2nd	SEK 1,500
3rd	SEK 500
Total	SEK 5,000

5.8 Retained Slot for Season 3

5.8.1 A Team keeps a slot in the RIVALS track in Season 3 if the same Slot Owner, or a transferee under 5.8.4, registers the Team in time and at least three of the people who played a Map in the Team's last Series in Season 2, identified by SteamID64, are in the Roster. The Team must meet Season 3's requirements for the Track, otherwise the slot is lost, but the Team may enter the LEGENDS track on the same terms as everyone else.

5.8.2 The slot gives entry only, never Seeding, a Group, a Bye, exemption from the Play-in or a place in the LEGENDS track, and the Team's results from Season 2 carry over on the Website.

5.8.3 The slot lapses if the conditions are not met, if it is not used in time, if the Team withdrew or was disqualified in Season 2 or if the Slot Owner gives it up by Support Ticket, and it is then not reallocated.

5.8.4 The slot may not be sold, merged, shared or lent. The Slot Owner may, by Support Ticket before registration closes, request that it be transferred to a person who is registered on rivalsleague.gg, connected to the continuing Team and without an interest in another Team in the Track, and otherwise the Head of Competitive Operations refuses the request, stating the reason.

6 Match rules

6.1 Servers, Server Configuration and Map Pool

6.1.1 All Maps are played on servers through Challengermode. The servers load `gamemode_competitive.cfg`, `gamemode_competitive_tmm.cfg`, Valve's exception list for Major tournaments (the section "Server Settings, Convars" in Valve's CS Major Supplemental Rulebook in the version in force on 2 October 2026, commit 8594dc0, 8 December 2025) and, last, the RIVALS block below. Everything else follows the Premier standard. Online, `mp_halftime_pausematch 0` also applies, and at the LAN Final `mp_halftime_pausematch 1`, the only value that differs. The Teams may check the values in the match log.

```
// rivals_match.cfg (run after gamemode_competitive, gamemode_competitive_tmm and the Valve Major list)
mp_maxrounds 24
mp_roundtime 1.92
mp_roundtime_defuse 1.92
mp_freezetime 20
mp_buytime 20
mp_c4timer 40
mp_startmoney 800
mp_maxmoney 16000
mp_round_restart_delay 5
mp_halftime 1
mp_overtime_enable 1
mp_overtime_maxrounds 6
mp_overtime_startmoney 12500
mp_overtime_limit 0
mp_team_timeout_max 3
mp_team_timeout_time 31
mp_team_timeout_ot_add_once 1
mp_team_timeout_ot_add_each 1
mp_team_timeout_ot_max 1
mp_technical_timeout_per_team 1
mp_technical_timeout_duration_s 120
cash_team_bonus_shorthanded 0
sv_matchpause_auto_5v5 0
mp_backup_round_auto 1
sv_steamauth_enforce 1
tv_enable 1
tv_delay 105
```

6.1.2 GOTV has a 105-second delay. Every Map is recorded as a Demo, which is available on the Match Page no later than one hour after the Series and is kept for at least twelve months after the Track's last Series.

6.1.3 Each Map is played on the Game Build that is current when the Map starts, and every Player must have it installed before the start. If Valve releases an update less than two hours before the start, and the server or a Player therefore cannot run the game, or the update causes an error that materially affects the game, the Match Admin may postpone the start by no more than 60 minutes or, except at the LAN Final, move the Series to a new time within 72 hours.

6.1.4 The Map Pool is Valve's Active Duty Map Pool on 21 October 2026 at 23:59 CEST and applies to the whole of Season 2 in both Tracks, including the LAN Final, even if Valve changes the pool later. At the time of publication it consists of Ancient, Anubis, Cache, Dust2, Inferno, Mirage and Nuke. If the pool differs at the freeze, the confirmed Map Pool is published in the Decisions Log before the first Series.

6.1.5 If Valve removes a Map from the game, or it becomes unplayable in competitive play, the League Commissioner replaces it with the Map most recently added to the Active Duty Map Pool that is not already included. The replacement is published in the Decisions Log and applies from the Track's first Series that starts at least 7 days later. Until then the Map Pool has six Maps and the six-Map variant in 6.6.3 applies.

6.1.6 Online, the Team is responsible for its own computer, peripherals, software, connection and power. Such faults are not the Organiser's responsibility, are handled within the Team's Technical Pause and are never force majeure. Equipment at the LAN Final is governed by 4.6.4.

6.2 Anti-cheat Program

6.2.1 Every Player and Substitute must have Akros Anti-Cheat running in Tournament Mode throughout every Map played online. The program is the same for all Teams. Instructions and system requirements are published on the Website no later than 9 October 2026 at 12:00 CEST. At the LAN Final, the Organiser provides computers with the program.

6.2.2 A Player without Akros running may not start or continue a Map, and the Team receives a Sanction under 7.4. If a Player is rejected for technical reasons not caused by unauthorised software, the Match Admin may grant a Technical Pause. Data from Akros may be used as evidence.

6.3 Voice communication and Coach

6.3.1 Online, that is in the LEGENDS Qualifier Stage including the Quarterfinals and throughout the RIVALS track, the Team uses its own voice channel, for example on Discord. Communication is unrestricted, and the Coach may speak at any time. During a Map, only the Starting Lineup, the Coach and Admins may be in the channel.

6.3.2 No later than Check-in, the Team Captain gives Competition Administration access to the voice channel. An Admin may listen and record at any time, with or without notice. If the Team cannot provide working access within 5 minutes of the request, the Team loses the current Map by Forfeit, or the next Map if the request is made before Map 1 or between Maps. The second time in the same Series, the Team loses the Series by Forfeit.

6.3.3 The Coach may never connect to the game server, not even as a spectator, and may never watch or listen to a broadcast or GOTV of their own Series. The consequence is set out in 7.4.1. A Coach who plays a Map as a registered Substitute (3.1.1) is a Player on that Map.

6.3.4 At the LAN Final, the Team communicates through the Organiser's equipment. The Coach stands or sits behind the Team and may speak to the Starting Lineup only during warm-up, Tactical Timeouts, the half-time break and the breaks between Maps. During Rounds, freetime and Technical Pauses the Coach stays silent and does not communicate by text or signs either. The Coach requests a Tactical Timeout through the Match Admin. Breaches are sanctioned under 7.4.1.

6.4 Scheduling

6.4.1 The Default Match Day is Tuesday at 19:00 in LEGENDS and Wednesday at 19:00 in RIVALS, with Mondays at 19:00 when the calendar says so, Swedish time. The Match Schedule takes precedence. A new time is set after both Team Captains have been heard and falls within the Track's calendar (4.4 and 5.5).

6.4.2 A Match Week runs from Monday at 00:00 to Sunday at 23:59. A Series in the Group Stage may be moved within the Match Week if the Team Captain, no later than 48 hours before the start, proposes at least three alternative times on Challengermode. The move only takes effect once both Team Captains have confirmed it no later than 48 hours before the original start, and the opponent does not have to accept any proposal. A Series in a Group's last round may not be moved to after the round's last playing time in the Match Schedule. Play-in, Quarterfinals, Playoffs and the LAN Final are not moved in this way.

6.4.3 No later than 7 days before the start, the Organiser announces and publishes which Series are Broadcast-locked Series. They are moved only under 6.1.3, 6.4.4 or 6.4.5 or in a documented emergency approved by the Head of Competitive Operations. Work, school and travel are not emergencies.

6.4.4 If Challengermode is not working, the Match Admin waits no more than 30 minutes. If the platform works again, the Series continues, and 6.5 is counted from the new start time announced by the Match Admin. Otherwise the Series is played manually in a lobby on the RIVALS CS2 Discord if the server works, with the veto under 6.6 and the result taken from the server log and Demo and confirmed by both Team Captains. If the server does not work, or the result cannot be secured within 60 minutes of the fault, the Series is moved to a new time within 72 hours, except at the LAN Final, where 4.6.8 applies. Maps already played stand, and an interrupted Map is resumed from the most recent backup.

6.4.5 Force majeure is an unforeseeable and extraordinary event outside the party's control, which the party could not reasonably have avoided and which is the sole reason an obligation cannot be fulfilled, for example fire, flood, strike or widespread disruption to power or transport. An affected Team immediately notifies the opponent and Competition Administration. The Head of Competitive Operations may postpone the Series within the Track's calendar and records the decision in the Decisions Log. The LAN Final follows 4.6.8.

6.5 Check-in and punctuality

6.5.1 Check-in opens on the Match Page 60 minutes before the start and closes when the Map Veto opens 15 minutes before the start. The Team then confirms the Starting Lineup for Map 1. The Players connect with their registered Game Account and player name.

6.5.2 The Team is Ready when all five Players in the Starting Lineup are on the server with the correct Game Accounts and the Map Veto is complete. The Team must be Ready at the start and, before Maps 2 and 3, when the break between Maps ends. If a Team has not checked in when the Map Veto opens, it is late from the start, and the opponent counts as Ready when its five Players are connected.

6.5.3 The Match Admin does not start a Map if the Starting Lineup breaches the residency rule in 2.3.1 or the VRS Roster in 3.4.2. The Team is then not Ready, but if the lineup is corrected before the Map is live, no Forfeit or Sanction follows. If a Map is played with the wrong Game Account, 2.4.3 applies.

6.5.4 Lateness is counted from the scheduled start until Ready. The highest step the lateness has reached applies, and the steps are not added together. The Match Admin enforces the penalty and notifies both Team Captains.

Lateness	Penalty
5 minutes	The Team loses one Tactical Timeout on Map 1
10 minutes	The Team loses two Tactical Timeouts on Map 1
15 minutes	The Team loses Map 1 by Forfeit
30 minutes	The Team loses the Series by Forfeit

6.5.5 Before Maps 2 and 3, lateness is counted from the end of the break, 10 minutes online and 15 minutes at the LAN Final, and the penalties apply to the Map to be played. If the Team has lost Map 1 through lateness, Map 2 is scheduled 25 minutes online and 30 minutes at the LAN Final after the original start, and the table is applied afresh from that time. Tactical Timeouts lost before Map 1 apply only to Map 1. Time lost because of an update, a platform fault, a server fault or a Match Admin decision is not counted. The Match Admin may waive the penalty only in the event of force majeure. An objection to a penalty is made to the Match Admin before the Map concerned starts, otherwise it is not considered.

6.5.6 If both Teams are late, each Team receives its own penalty. If both reach 15 minutes, neither loses the Map, but both lose all their Tactical Timeouts on it. If both reach 30 minutes, the following applies:

- a) Group Stage: double Forfeit. Neither Team receives Table Points, and two Maps are recorded as 0-13 for both, that is 0 Rounds Won and -26 in Round Differential each.
- b) Quarterfinal and RIVALS Playoffs except the Grand Final: both are eliminated and the next opponent advances by Forfeit.

- c) Semifinal at the LAN Final: both are eliminated and share third place with SEK 3,000 each. The winner of the other Semifinal wins the Final by Forfeit, the loser finishes second and the Third-place Match is not played.
- d) Play-in, Final, Third-place Match and the Grand Final: the Head of Competitive Operations moves the Series once, within 72 hours or, at the LAN Final, on the same day. If both reach 30 minutes again, then in the Final, the Third-place Match and the Grand Final the Team with the lowest number in the Seed List (in RIVALS, the list after Play-in) receives the higher placing, and the prize money for the two placings is split equally. In Play-in, both are eliminated and the winner's place in the Group Stage is handled as a Vacancy under 5.6.1.

6.6 Map Veto and Knife Round

6.6.1 The Team Captains carry out the Map Veto on Challengermode. It opens 15 minutes before the start and must be completed 10 minutes before the start. Each step has 30 seconds, after which the system makes a random choice.

6.6.2 The Higher Seed chooses Team A or Team B. In the Group Stage, Play-in and Tiebreaker Deciders, the Higher Seed is the Team with the lowest number in the Seed List (in RIVALS, after Play-in). In the Quarterfinals, the LAN Final and the RIVALS Playoffs except the Grand Final, it is the Team with the best Group placing, then the lowest seeding number. In the Grand Final, the Team from the Upper Bracket chooses.

6.6.3 All Series, including Tiebreaker Deciders, follow the Bo3 sequence. If the Map Pool temporarily has six Maps (6.1.5), the six-Map variant applies.

Step	Bo3, seven Maps	Six Maps
1	Higher Seed chooses Team A or Team B	Same
2	Team A removes a Map	Same
3	Team B removes a Map	Same
4	Team A picks Map 1	Same
5	Team B picks the Starting Side on Map 1	Same
6	Team B picks Map 2	Same
7	Team A picks the Starting Side on Map 2	Same
8	Team A removes a Map	Same
9	Team B removes a Map	The remaining Map is Map 3, Starting Side by Knife Round
10	The remaining Map is Map 3, Starting Side by Knife Round	Omitted

6.6.4 The Starting Side is CT or T for the first Half. The veto and the chosen Starting Sides apply to the whole Series, even after a Restart or Round Restore. The Knife Round is played before the Map starts and does not count as a Round. Only knives may be used, purchases are disabled and no grenades may be used. The winner chooses the Starting Side with the command on Challengermode or through the Match Admin. If a grenade is thrown or a shot is fired, regardless of damage, or a Player is missing from the server, the Knife Round is restarted once. If it happens again, the other Team chooses, and if both have breached, the Higher Seed chooses.

6.7 During the Map

6.7.1 The Series is played Bo3, and the first to two Maps wins. A Map is won by the Team that first wins 13 Rounds, and the Teams switch sides after Round 12. At 12-12, Overtime of no more than six Rounds is played, where the first to four wins, and Overtimes are played until the Map is decided. Each Player starts Overtime with 12,500 dollars in the game's currency. The Teams start on the side from the previous Half and switch after three Rounds.

6.7.2 A Map never starts with fewer than five Players in a Team, and such a Team is not Ready. The Map is live when freetime in Round 1 ends. Before then, the Match Admin carries out a Restart without penalty in the event of a setup error, for example the wrong Server Configuration, Map or Starting Side or the wrong Player. After that, the whole Map is never restarted.

6.7.3 Each Team has three Tactical Timeouts of 30 seconds per Map and one per Overtime. Unused timeouts are not carried over. A Player calls the timeout with the in-game vote, and at the LAN Final the Coach may request it through the Match Admin. If the Team loses its next Tactical Timeout and has none left on the Map, it is deducted on the next Map, and if there is no next Map, the loss has no effect. Half-time is not a Tactical Timeout. Online there is no half-time break, and the side switch instead takes place during the server's 15 seconds. At the LAN Final, the half-time break is no more than 2 minutes, and a Team that is not ready plays on with the Players who are present.

6.7.4 A Technical Pause may only be called for a technical problem that prevents a Player from playing, and the reason is written in the chat immediately. At the LAN Final it is called through the Match Admin. Each Team has 10 minutes of Technical Pause per Map, and the built-in 120-second technical timeout is included in the 10 minutes. The rest is taken with Challengermode's pause command. Pauses decided by the Match Admin or caused by the Organiser's equipment are not counted. When the time is up, the Team chooses to play on with the connected Players or to lose the Map by Forfeit. Reporting a bug or a suspected rule breach is never abuse. Calling a pause without a technical problem or extending it after the problem has been solved is abuse and is sanctioned under 7.4. The Team may not pause or resume the game on its own. The first time in the Series this results in a Warning and thereafter in the loss of the next Tactical Timeout, with a Map Forfeit as the most severe Sanction.

6.7.5 If a Player loses connection, the Team calls a Technical Pause itself. If this happened before anyone had taken damage from an opponent and before the bomb was planted, the Round is replayed if the Team requests it before the next Round is completed. Otherwise the Round is played to the end. A Team playing four against five receives no extra economic compensation. Substitutions are made only between Maps.

6.7.6 If the server crashes, the current Round is restored with the economy from the start of the Round. A Round that had already been decided counts. If there is no usable backup, the nearest earlier one is loaded and the Rounds after it are replayed. Incorrect server settings raised in time under 7.2.1 are corrected by a Round Restore to the most recent correct Round, unless both Team Captains state in writing that they want to play on. If the issue is raised later, the setting is corrected from the next Round and Rounds already played stand.

6.7.7 Exploiting bugs and exploits is prohibited, including pixel walking, planting the bomb where it cannot be defused or cannot be heard, moving through walls, ceilings or floors, manipulating map features with objects, and boosting that gives vision through solid textures or reaches the skybox. Other boosting, covering the bomb with objects, normal fire spread and settings in the graphics card drivers are permitted. If an exploit has decided a Round and it is reported before the next Round is completed, the Round is replayed. Otherwise 7.4 applies.

6.7.8 The break between Maps is 10 minutes online and 15 minutes at the LAN Final. A new Starting Lineup is confirmed under 3.3.1.

6.8 Results and tiebreakers

6.8.1 Both Team Captains confirm or dispute the result on Challengermode within 15 minutes after the Series, otherwise the recorded result stands. The right to Protest is not affected. Challengermode is the official record for results and the Website for standings. A discrepancy between them is corrected within 24 hours of being discovered or reported and is recorded in the Decisions Log.

6.8.2 In the Group Stage, a win gives 3 Table Points and a loss 0, also in the case of a Forfeit. A Series cannot end in a draw. Play-in and knockout stages give no Table Points.

6.8.3 A Series decided by Forfeit before any Map has been played is recorded as 2-0, and each Map decided by Forfeit as 13-0, that is +13 and -13 respectively in Round Differential. If the Series is decided by Forfeit while it is in progress, Maps already played stand and the rest are recorded as 13-0. If a Team loses by Forfeit after the Series has ended, it is recorded as 2-0 and each Map as 13-0, regardless of the result played.

6.8.4 In the event of a Team's Withdrawal or Disqualification after the Groups have been published, all its results are struck if it has played fewer than half of its Series. A Forfeit counts as played. Otherwise the results stand and the rest become Forfeits to the opponents. The decision is published in the Decisions Log.

6.8.5 Equal Table Points are separated in the following order. When a step separates out any Team, the Tiebreaker restarts from step 1 for the Teams that are still level.

Step	Criterion
1	Table Points in a mini-table with only the Series between the tied Teams
2	Round Differential in the Series between the tied Teams
3	Round Differential in all Series in the Group
4	Rounds Won in all Series in the Group
5	Tiebreaker Decider in Bo3, only when exactly two Teams are level and the tie decides advancement
6	Initial seeding order: lowest number in the Seed List, in RIVALS the list after Play-in. Used when step 5 does not apply

6.8.6 Round Differential is Rounds won minus Rounds lost, including Overtime and Forfeit Maps. A Tiebreaker Decider is played on the Track's reserve date (4.4 and 5.5) or, if there is none, in LEGENDS no later than 14 January 2027 at 23:59 CET and in RIVALS no later than the day before the first round of the Playoffs. It is played with the Bo3 sequence, gives no Table Points and does not affect Round Differential or Rounds Won.

7 Conduct, protests and sanctions

7.1 Integrity and conduct

7.1.1 Cheating is any action or aid that gives an advantage not permitted by the game or the Rulebook. Input Automation, that is hardware, software or binds that by themselves perform, combine or determine movement or shooting commands, for example snap tap, SOCD handling, null binds and multi-command scripts, and Ghosting, that is the Starting Lineup or the Coach receiving information about the ongoing Series from a broadcast, GOTV or another source outside the Team, count as Cheating. Input Automation must be switched off throughout the Series. Match-fixing is influencing or attempting to influence a result other than by playing to win, including offering, requesting or accepting benefits for doing so. Cheating, Match-fixing and Betting on the Competition, personally or through someone else, are prohibited and are established by the Disciplinary Board after review of the Demo, with consequences under 2.7. Officials, employees and contractors of the Organiser may not engage in Betting on the Competition either.

7.1.2 Participants must behave respectfully and may not harass, threaten, insult or discriminate against anyone on the grounds of sex, transgender identity or expression, ethnicity, religion or other belief, disability, sexual orientation or age, during or outside Series and in all channels connected with the Competition. The Match Admin's instructions apply immediately, even if the Team considers them wrong. Refusal results in a Warning, and a more severe Sanction, at most a Map Forfeit, requires a previous Warning for the same matter in the same Series.

7.1.3 Anyone who discovers a bug, an incorrect setting or a suspected rule breach reports it directly to the Match Admin. A suggestion of Match-fixing or Betting is reported without delay to the Head of Competitive Operations. A report does not replace a Protest.

7.2 Protests

7.2.1 An issue during a Map is raised with the Match Admin in the Match Chat before the next Round is completed, in the Map's last Round before the next Map is live, and in the Series' last Round as a Match Protest. Otherwise the result of the Rounds played stands. The Match Admin's decision applies immediately and cannot be appealed while the Map is in progress.

7.2.2 The Team Captain submits a Match Protest by Support Ticket no later than 30 minutes after the Series online, and at the LAN Final before the next Series or, after the day's last Series, within 30 minutes. Facts of play, that is the game's own outcome and the Match Admin's judgement of it in the moment, cannot be protested, but the application of the rules to them can be reviewed under 7.3.

7.2.3 An Integrity Protest concerning Cheating, the wrong person on the account, Match-fixing or Betting is submitted no later than 72 hours after the Series and before the next stage if advancement is affected. The Head of Competitive Operations also investigates on their own initiative, up to and including 31 December 2027, and repayment of prize money follows 8.2.3. A Protest states the Series, Map, Round, Demo tick, rule, evidence and the action requested.

7.2.4 Online, decisions are made within 48 hours after the Protest was received, and at the LAN Final before the next Series. The Head of Competitive Operations may extend the time for an Integrity Protest by no more than 72 hours when two reviewers with no connection to the Teams need to go through the Demo, which is required for a decision on Cheating. Cases of Cheating, Match-fixing, Betting and serious misconduct are handed over to the Disciplinary Board, which decides them within 72 hours of the handover and, during the LAN Days (29 and 30 January 2027), before the next Series of the LAN Final starts. Until then the recorded result applies. Late Protests are rejected. Deadlines are counted in Swedish time and also run over weekends.

7.3 Appeals and publication

7.3.1 Any decision by a Match Admin may, on request, be reviewed by the Head of Competitive Operations. The Team Captain requests review by Support Ticket within 24 hours, and during the LAN Final before the next Series.

7.3.2 Decisions on Eligibility, Disqualification, placing and Sanctions more severe than a Warning can be appealed to the Review Committee, which consists of three people with no connection to the case and decides within 72 hours by majority. The Appeal must have been received within 24 hours when the next stage is affected and otherwise within 7 days.

7.3.3 A Disqualification is never suspended by an Appeal. Other Sanctions are suspended, unless the Head of Competitive Operations decides, with stated reasons, that the integrity of the Competition requires otherwise. During the LAN Days, decisions apply immediately and the Review Committee reviews them afterwards.

7.3.4 Decisions that change the standings, Eligibility, placing or a Sanction more severe than a Warning are published in the Decisions Log on the same day.

7.4 Sanctions

7.4.1 A Sanction must be proportionate, and the same breach gives the same Sanction regardless of Team, Track, Seeding, stage or broadcast. The Team is responsible for its Participants. Sanctions apply only within Season 2, except Suspension from future seasons, which only the Disciplinary Board decides, and never restrict participation in other organisers' competitions. Accommodation and Travel Reimbursement are never withheld. The standard Sanction applies unless aggravating circumstances (repetition, intent, affected result, attempt to conceal) or mitigating circumstances (self-reporting, no affected result, first breach, immediate correction) justify otherwise within the range. Fixed means that the Sanction does not change.

Breach	Standard Sanction	Range
Lateness	Under 6.5.4	Fixed
Abuse of Technical Pause	First time in the Series: loss of the next Tactical Timeout. Second time: Map Forfeit on the current Map	Fixed
Coach breaches 6.3	Online, the Coach on the game server or with a broadcast or GOTV of their own Series (6.3.3): loss of the Series by Forfeit and referral to the Disciplinary Board as suspected Ghosting. At the LAN Final (6.3.4), first time in the Series: loss of the next Tactical Timeout. Second time: the Coach leaves the player area for the rest of the Series. Third time in the Track, online breaches included: may not act as Coach for the rest of the Track	Fixed
Unregistered or ineligible Player	Loss of the Series, reviewed under 2.7	Fixed
Bug or exploit	First time in the Track: Warning. Second time: Map Forfeit on that Map	Fixed
Offensive language	Warning	Up to Suspension for one Series
Discriminatory harassment	Suspension for one Series and referral to the Disciplinary Board	Up to Suspension for three Series
Player Stream without approval or with less than 4 minutes' delay	First time: Warning. Second time: loss of the right to Player Stream for the rest of Season 2	Warning to loss of the right
Missed Media Obligation	First time: Warning. Thereafter prize money is withheld until a replacement obligation has been fulfilled	Fixed
On-site conduct at the LAN Final	Warning	Up to removal from the venue for the rest of the day
Map without Akros in Tournament Mode	Map Forfeit. Second time in the Series: loss of the Series	Fixed

7.4.2 No Sanction, alone or together with others, results in Disqualification. That can only happen on the grounds in 2.7.

8 Broadcast, media and prizes

8.1 Broadcast and media

8.1.1 The Organiser holds all rights to broadcast, record and reproduce Series, live and afterwards, and may license them to third parties on the same terms. All Official Broadcast and all official content is free to watch, without a fee or subscription.

8.1.2 A Participant may broadcast their own perspective (Player Stream) only after approval by Support Ticket before the Series starts, for the channel stated. A Player Stream must have a delay of at least 4 minutes throughout the Series, be free to watch and may not be broadcast from the player area of the LAN Final. An Admin may order a broadcast that breaches 8.1 to be stopped immediately.

8.1.3 Official Broadcast may be rebroadcast only with specific approval, and sponsor segments and sponsor graphics may not be covered, muted or altered. Participants and Officials may not broadcast, cast or commentate on another Team's ongoing Series without written approval, for example through the community caster programme (rivalsleague.gg/community-casting).

8.1.4 Media Obligations are an interview after the Series when the Match Admin requests it, the LEGENDS media day on 29 January 2027 (4.6.2) and reasonable requests for social media content, made at least 48 hours in advance and no more than 15 minutes per Participant and Match Week. They are the same for all Teams in the same stage of a Track. The Organiser and its partners may use the name, image, voice and gameplay material of the Team and the Participants relating to the Competition, without compensation and without presenting anyone as endorsing a product.

8.2 Prizes

8.2.1 Prize money is paid out through Challengermode in euros, converted from SEK at the Riksbank's most recently published reference rate before the payout date, within 10 days after the Track's last Series. At the planned end date, the last day is 9 February 2027 in LEGENDS and 26 December 2026 in RIVALS (27 December 2026 if the Grand Final is played on 17 December), at 23:59 CET. The recipient must have an account that meets Challengermode's requirements for payouts.

8.2.2 Before the last payout day, the Team Captain chooses by Support Ticket between the full amount to the Team Captain and equal shares to each Participant who has played at least one Map, in LEGENDS during the LAN Days and in RIVALS in the Team's last Series in which the Team played a Map. If no choice is made, equal shares are paid out. For a Participant under 18, the amount is paid to their own account only with the Guardian's consent, otherwise to the Guardian.

8.2.3 The recipient is responsible for their own tax. A disqualified Team receives no placing and no prize money, and that money is not redistributed. If a Team is disqualified after Payout, the prize money is repaid within 30 days. No Team or Participant receives any compensation or benefit from the Organiser, in money or in any other form, whether appearance fees or revenue share, other than the prizes in 4.8 and 5.7 and Accommodation and Travel Reimbursement in 4.6.7.

Appendix Brackets

B.1 The appendix shows the Group allocation and brackets. If the appendix and section 4 or 5 differ, the sections apply.

The LEGENDS track

B.2 Snake Seeding. Numbers higher than the number of Teams are not used.

Group	Two Groups (8 to 16 Teams)	Four Groups (17 to 32 Teams)
A	1, 4, 5, 8, 9, 12, 13, 16	1, 8, 9, 16, 17, 24, 25, 32
B	2, 3, 6, 7, 10, 11, 14, 15	2, 7, 10, 15, 18, 23, 26, 31
C		3, 6, 11, 14, 19, 22, 27, 30
D		4, 5, 12, 13, 20, 21, 28, 29

B.3 Group sizes with 17 to 32 Teams, in the order Group A, B, C and D.

Teams	A, B, C, D	Teams	A, B, C, D
17	5, 4, 4, 4	25	7, 6, 6, 6
18	5, 5, 4, 4	26	7, 7, 6, 6
19	5, 5, 5, 4	27	7, 7, 7, 6
20	5, 5, 5, 5	28	7, 7, 7, 7
21	5, 5, 5, 6	29	7, 7, 7, 8
22	5, 5, 6, 6	30	7, 7, 8, 8
23	5, 6, 6, 6	31	7, 8, 8, 8
24	6, 6, 6, 6	32	8, 8, 8, 8

B.4 Rounds and Series per Team in Single Round Robin.

Teams in the Group	Rounds	Series per Team	Byes per Team
4	3	3	0
5	5	4	1
6	5	5	0
7	7	6	1
8	7	7	0

B.5 Path from the Group Stage (3 November 2026 to 10 January 2027) to the LAN Final.

Series	With 16 Teams	With 17 to 32 Teams	Outcome
Quarterfinal 1	Not played	A1 vs B2	Winner to Semifinal 1
Quarterfinal 2	Not played	D1 vs C2	Winner to Semifinal 1
Quarterfinal 3	Not played	B1 vs A2	Winner to Semifinal 2
Quarterfinal 4	Not played	C1 vs D2	Winner to Semifinal 2
Semifinal 1	A1 vs B2	Winner of Quarterfinal 1 vs winner of Quarterfinal 2	Winner to the Final, loser to the Third-place Match
Semifinal 2	B1 vs A2	Winner of Quarterfinal 3 vs winner of Quarterfinal 4	Winner to the Final, loser to the Third-place Match
Third-place Match	Loser of Semifinal 1 vs loser of Semifinal 2	Same	Third and fourth place
Final	Winner of Semifinal 1 vs winner of Semifinal 2	Same	First and second place

The RIVALS track**B.6** Bracket for four Teams, Band A and Band B. All Series are played Bo3 at 19:00 CET.

Round and date	Series	Matchup	Winner to	Loser to
1, Wednesday 2 December 2026	Upper semifinal 1	First-placed vs fourth-placed (one Group) or A1 vs B2 (two Groups)	Upper final	Lower round 1
1, Wednesday 2 December 2026	Upper semifinal 2	Second-placed vs third-placed (one Group) or B1 vs A2 (two Groups)	Upper final	Lower round 1
2, Monday 7 December 2026	Upper final	Winners of upper semifinals 1 and 2	Grand Final	Lower final

Round and date	Series	Matchup	Winner to	Loser to
2, Monday 7 December 2026	Lower round 1	Losers of upper semifinals 1 and 2	Lower final	Eliminated, 4th place
3, Wednesday 9 December 2026	Lower final	Loser of the upper final vs winner of lower round 1	Grand Final	Eliminated, 3rd place
4, Wednesday 16 December 2026	Grand Final	Winner of the upper final vs winner of the lower final	1st place	2nd place

B.7 Bracket for eight Teams, Band C. All Series are played Bo3 at 19:00 CET.

Round and date	Series	Matchup	Winner to	Loser to
1, Wednesday 25 November 2026	Upper quarterfinal 1	A1 vs B2	Upper semifinal 1	Lower round 1, match a
1, Wednesday 25 November 2026	Upper quarterfinal 2	D1 vs C2	Upper semifinal 1	Lower round 1, match a
1, Wednesday 25 November 2026	Upper quarterfinal 3	B1 vs A2	Upper semifinal 2	Lower round 1, match b
1, Wednesday 25 November 2026	Upper quarterfinal 4	C1 vs D2	Upper semifinal 2	Lower round 1, match b
2, Monday 30 November 2026	Upper semifinal 1	Winners of upper quarterfinals 1 and 2	Upper final	Lower round 2, match b
2, Monday 30 November 2026	Upper semifinal 2	Winners of upper quarterfinals 3 and 4	Upper final	Lower round 2, match a
2, Monday 30 November 2026	Lower round 1, match a	Losers of upper quarterfinals 1 and 2	Lower round 2, match a	Eliminated, shared 7th to 8th place
2, Monday 30 November 2026	Lower round 1, match b	Losers of upper quarterfinals 3 and 4	Lower round 2, match b	Eliminated, shared 7th to 8th place
3, Wednesday 2 December 2026	Upper final	Winners of upper semifinals 1 and 2	Grand Final	Lower final
3, Wednesday 2 December 2026	Lower round 2, match a	Winner of lower round 1, match a, vs loser of upper semifinal 2	Lower round 3	Eliminated, shared 5th to 6th place
3, Wednesday 2 December 2026	Lower round 2, match b	Winner of lower round 1, match b, vs loser of upper semifinal 1	Lower round 3	Eliminated, shared 5th to 6th place
4, Monday 7 December 2026	Lower round 3	Winners of lower round 2, match a and match b	Lower final	Eliminated, 4th place
5, Wednesday 9 December 2026	Lower final	Loser of the upper final vs winner of lower round 3	Grand Final	Eliminated, 3rd place
6, Wednesday 16 December 2026	Grand Final	Winner of the upper final vs winner of the lower final	1st place	2nd place